Michael Braithwaite

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EDUCATION

Colorado College — *Colorado Springs, Colorado*

Bachelor of Arts in Physics — May 2024
Minor: Journalism — GPA: 3.43

WORK EXPERIENCE

The Gazette — *Hybrid-Denver, Colorado*

Digital Strategist and Reporter — **February 2026-Present**

- Create clean, effective data visuals and interactive maps using advanced Google Sheets, Microsoft Excel and GIS software while collaborating with reporters on tight deadlines for local and statewide stories.
- Build back-end, auto-updating dashboards using Claude Code to streamline newsroom workflows and compare to market competitors.
- Report part-time on the regional transportation beat, analyzing financial documents to produce data journalism showing Denver's local transit network's structural budget deficit and its inability to rectify it.
- Analyze data such as pageviews, reader retention and click-through rate to determine the performance of over 50 daily published stories for The Gazette's Denver publication.
- Develop effective audience plans focused around trending topics to create trending social media campaigns using online news content.

Breaking News and General Assignment Reporter — **April 2025-February 2026**

- Reported on breaking news and enterprise stories, both in the Denver area as well as throughout Colorado, for one of the largest media outlets in the state.
- Covered crime, courts, the economy, protests, wildfires and a variety of other stories while also conducting longform investigations into infrastructure, the economy and the state's prison system.

Overnight Editorial Assistant — **December 2024-March 2025**

- Independently compiled digital assets to place into the e-edition of the paper.
- Coordinated publishing timelines, troubleshot production errors and ensured finalized proofs met strict quality control standards.
- Took on breaking news responsibilities in a part-time role.

SPJ Colorado Pro — *Hybrid-Denver, Colorado*

Board Member — **June 2026-Present**

- Coordinate events and social media campaigns designed to provide resources, training and outreach to current and aspiring journalists throughout metro Denver, and the Rocky Mountain region.
- Strategize plans to modernize the internal and external operations and communications of the chapter.

flytedesk — *Remote*

Client Support Coordinator (Fall Fellow) — **June 2024-December 2024**

- Created media plans using Airtable, Google Sheets and Looker Studio software for advertising campaigns that were implemented on college campuses while working as an intern on the political elections team.
- Maintained and updated back-end databases to ensure cross-platform integration and time-saving efficiency during a turbulent general election cycle.
- Built centralized data repositories, pitch decks and political surveys for both internal and external purposes.

The Catalyst Newspaper — *Colorado Springs, Colorado*

Editor-in-Chief — **December 2022-December 2023**

- Coordinated administrative procedures and project management for Colorado College's student newspaper.
- Crafted expense reports and budget models to create a sustainable organizational financial structure.
- Created an organizational handbook to ensure continuity of processes and standards.

Awards

- Rising Star Award at the 2026 Colorado Press Association's Local News Solutions Convention.
- First Place, Best Data Journalism Reporting award (Colorado Press Association. 2026).

Skills

- Data analysis (Google Sheets, Excel, SQL, Python, R), data visualization (ArcGIS, Looker Studio, Tableau), Claude AI, reporting, writing, editing, media planning, AP style.